



MONTHLY UPDATE

ICT Industry: monthly update, August 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

17 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

ALGERIA · BOTSWANA · EGYPT · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ESWATINI · GABON · GHANA · MOROCCO · NIGER ·
NIGERIA · SENEGAL · SOUTH AFRICA · SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The state's electronics industry began selling digital infrastructure rather than devices. Its electronics firm, in a consortium with two other companies, [signed a protocol with the coordination of a Congolese new-city expansion project for digital technologies, electronic payment systems, digital equipment and associated services, with knowledge transfer and a centre for innovation covering payment systems, cybersecurity and applied artificial intelligence](#), signed before this country's ambassador. No amount is stated by any party, so what is recorded is the direction of travel rather than a commitment: the firm had previously exported only payment terminals into the same market.

Botswana

The state wholesale network operator [presented its first integrated report, for the year ended 31 March 2025, at its annual general meeting on 13 August, with revenue down on the year, and reported its 2025/26 local access projects complete](#). Publishing an integrated report is itself part of the movement: the operator has not accounted for itself in one document before.

Egypt

A group inaugurated its Middle East and Africa regional headquarters and first global generative-AI centre of excellence in New Cairo on 28 July, backed by a company-stated US\$100m with about 800 staff ([inauguration account](#)).

Equatorial Guinea

Salvador Nguema Funtam took over at GITGE with a new deputy, the outcome of the July selection process.

The consultancy AVANTE brought public institutions, banks and technology firms to the Hotel Anda China in Malabo on 22 July with the backing of the national development agency ANDGE. Panellists included the ministry's director-general for artificial intelligence, GITGE's technical director and BANGE's deputy head of digital and electronic banking.

The base's first record of a national e-commerce platform arrived on 14 August, when the economy ministry and [SelBa24 met to organise the country's first e-commerce and digital-payments seminar-workshop](#), to run simultaneously in Malabo and Bata between September and October and to train SMEs, traders and farmers to open and run free online stores on the platform. Nothing about SelBa24 itself — its ownership, merchant count, transaction volume or launch date — is stated.

Eswatini

A state-facing platform changed hands rather than being built. The [Taiwan-funded platform connecting local businesses to wider markets was handed over to the investment promotion authority at the international trade fair on 3 September, with funding for a third-phase scale-up still being sought](#). No listing count, transaction volume, cost or phase-three budget is published, so what the state has taken on is a platform whose running costs are unstated.

Gabon

A ride-hailing platform [began recruiting drivers at Libreville in partnership with a local transport operator, without announcing a launch date, the cities it will serve, its tariffs or its regulatory framework](#). It works as a pure intermediary with no fleet or drivers of its own, entering a market where one competitor has operated since 2021 and electric taxis were deployed in late 2025 under a state-backed project.

Ghana

On 27 July a company filed a writ claiming authorship of the 2007 design of the dominant mobile-money platform; the operator answered on 31 July that the claims are without merit and it will contest fully.

Morocco

The industry and trade ministry [added video games to the innovation funding programme](#), so companies in the sector can now apply for government funding to develop and test new games. No allocation, ceiling or first award has been published.

Niger

Hardware assembly is the one industrial position with a date attached. A government delegation inspecting the electronics plant at Hamdallaye [put it at 63 per cent complete and due in service by the end of October 2026, to assemble smartphones, computers and tablets](#). A completion percentage and a month are more than most rows in this report carry; what is absent is everything downstream of the building — capacity, cost, ownership and who buys the output.

Nigeria

[Mobile money revenue at the largest operator grew about 132% in the first half and active wallets rose 1.3 million to five million](#), while suspending a single airtime-lending product took second-quarter fintech revenue to ₦12.99bn, down 72.4% year on year — establishing that the book the market had read as a payments business was substantially an airtime-lending business.

Senegal

A French insurance-technology company [acquired Tanel, a Senegalese health-technology firm, in what the account calls a rare francophone health-technology exit](#). No price, range or cash-and-stock split was disclosed by either side and the company's revenue was withheld, so nothing here can be put against the sector's other exits. What the transaction does establish is a buyer outside the region taking a Senegalese health platform, which is the first such disposal on this ledger.

South Africa

The sector's transformation body lost its chair. The communications minister [replaced the B-BBEE ICT Sector Council's chairperson and appointed an interim chair for six months](#) on 14 August, after a departmental investigation found the council dysfunctional. The investigation report is not published, and no remedial plan, terms of reference for the interim period or date for a permanent appointment is stated.

The informal economy became a data product. A listed payments company [began selling near-real-time item-level intelligence on informal retail, drawn from a point-of-sale network of over 90,000 spaza shops and taverns and 10,500 checkouts, to consumer-goods brands, wholesalers and financiers](#). The network figures are the company's own, and no consent basis or data-protection assessment for reselling merchant transaction data is stated.

Platform transport worked the other end of the same problem — getting drivers inside a licensing regime rather than getting data out of them. An e-hailing operator [took its compliance programme to the provinces, holding a North West regulatory engagement in Rustenburg on 18 August attended by more than 150 operators and a Western Cape transport dialogue in Cape Town on 21 August at which the provincial mobility department's director of licensing and adjudication undertook to add e-hailing as a service option on the operating-licence application; the North West provincial regulatory entity put its pending operating-licence backlog at 3,000 to 5,000 applications](#). The account is the platform's own and the undertaking is not yet an amended form.

Sudan

Domestic production is a licensable activity and nothing establishes that it is an occupied one. The regulator's licensing framework includes [a technical support licence category explicitly for basic infrastructure manufacturing](#). No register of holders of that category, and no production or employment figure, was located.

Tanzania

The sector has multiplied and says it cannot scale. A United Nations capital development fund [counts 171 active fintech companies in 2026 against 33 in 2021, alongside more than 70 per cent of adults holding a mobile money account and 6.4 billion digital payment transactions in 2024](#), and founders told a Dar es Salaam session that partnerships with banks and mobile operators remain the main barrier - banks assessing early-stage firms through a static lens, the core processing layer commoditised as institutions build in house, limited patient capital, talent shortages, regulatory and tax uncertainty and the cost of acquiring customers. The stated ambition is to be a leading African fintech market by 2031, with no intermediate target on file.

One account of the trading economy the fintech count sits above reached the base: an e-commerce sector that runs on [an Instagram storefront, a WhatsApp sales desk, a mobile-money rail, a motorcycle courier for the last mile and long-distance buses across the border](#), rather than on platforms with catalogues and checkout. It is a reported description rather than a measurement, and the base holds no transaction volume, merchant count or dispute mechanism for any part of it.

Togo

Fuel marking and traceability began at Lome, the obligation having applied since 1 July: every litre through legal channels carries a molecular marker verifiable at depot, station and roadside, with sanctions running to seizure and closure. Neither the contract amendment nor the marking regulation is held, and no contract value, duration or data-ownership term is published.

Zambia

The third edition of a continental diversity report puts 29% of Zambian startups sampled with at least one female co-founder, the highest of any country covered, and 22.6% with a female chief executive, against a continental 19.2% female co-founded from a sample of more than 3,000. The underlying report is not held; only the trade-press account is.

Zimbabwe

A locally built enterprise platform was formally launched at a university technology expo on 30 July, its developer already carrying systems across 83 local authorities and government projects including a mines export permit system and the citizen engagement platform. It is the base's clearest instance of Zimbabwean-written software at national scale; no licence value, contract or user figure is stated.

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